

Integrate direct-to-device satellite services for resilient tactical communications in defense operations.

Defense × Tactical and mission-critical communications × Satellite and non-terrestrial networks · OS150 v1 · refreshed 2026-08-18

ATTRACTIVENESS	RIGHT TO WIN	COMPETITION	SERVICEABLE MARKET	HORIZON	PORTFOLIO
68 is the world moving	22 can we play, can we win	MEDIUM 2 named in the evidence	€95.9m observed evidence · per year	NOW budgeted procurement within 1...	L3 7 signals

Attractiveness and right to win are scored and displayed separately and are never combined (SC-12). Competition is a fourth quantity, not a discount on either.

Evidence gap (SC-13). Orange has 0.0 published reference(s) in Defense, below the threshold of 5. A customer conversation here has no proof point behind it yet.

The opportunity

This opportunity integrates direct-to-device satellite services into tactical communications for defense operations, ensuring resilient connectivity when terrestrial networks are degraded or unavailable. It targets defense ministries and agencies procuring military electronic systems, as evidenced by recent tenders, and is relevant now because satellite direct-to-device technology is maturing and being positioned as a complement to existing mobile networks.

Market opportunity

Method	Total (TAM)	Serviceable (SAM)	Obtainable (SOM)	Confidence
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised	€95.9m	€95.9m	€120k	observed

All figures are annual, in EUR. Ranges compound the uncertainty of each factor below; the base case is the middle column of each.

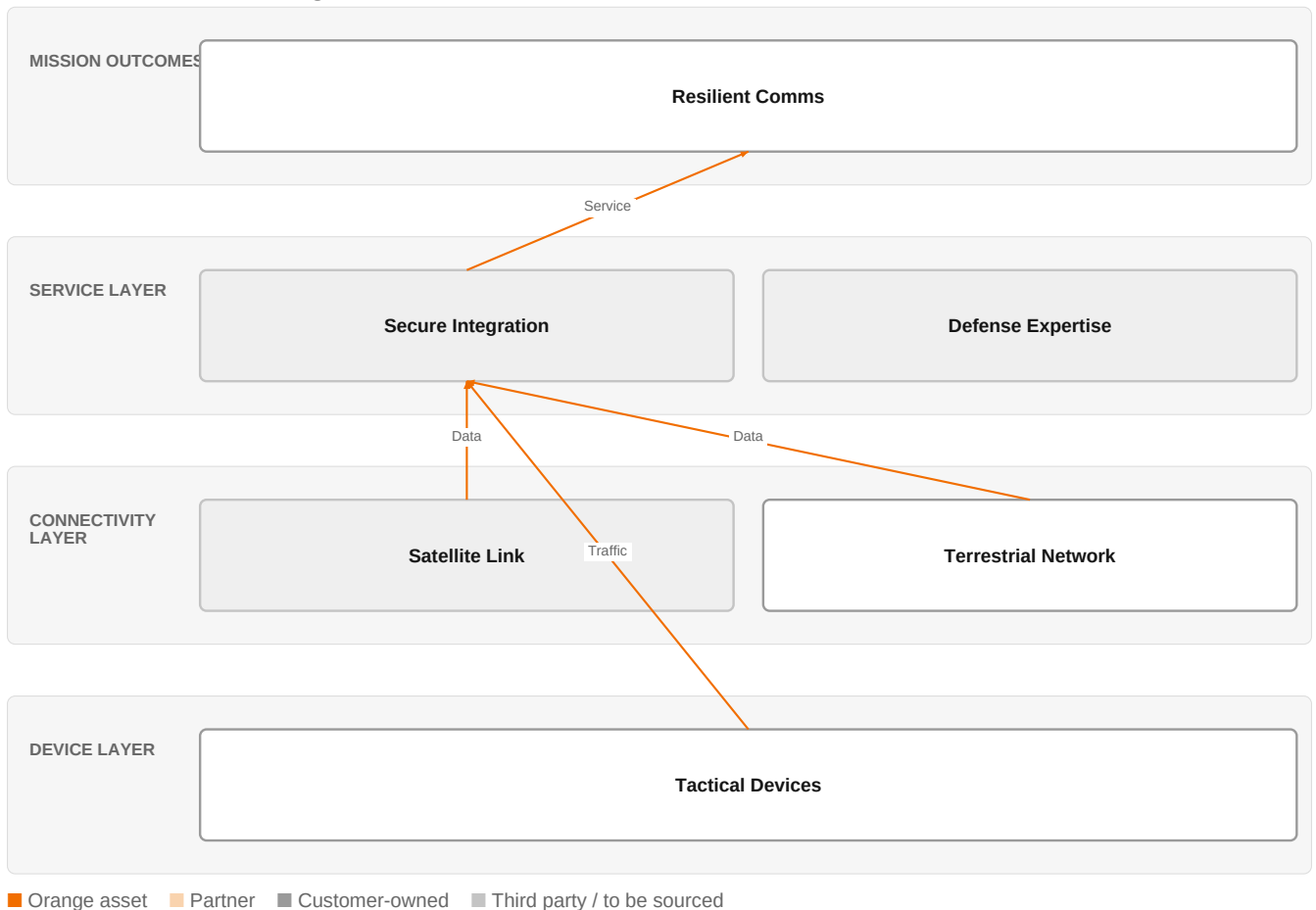
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised

Factor	Value	Basis	Source	As of
Tendered contract value in matching CPV categories	€95.9m per year	observed	TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted	2026-05-21..2026-08-05
Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market	0.1 % of SAM	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share	size-2026-08-a

Read this before quoting the number. Observed over 85 days of TED coverage and scaled to a year (x4.3); a short collection window makes that scaling rough. 5 matching notices, matched on vertical via the CPV crosswalk — §4.5.2's warning applies: a crosswalk error lands directly in this number. Public procurement only. Private-sector demand for the same capability is not visible here at all, so this is a floor rather than a market size. 1 of 2 declared geographies are outside the European reference data (US); the estimate covers the European footprint only.

The solution, in one picture

Secure Tactical Satellite Integration



This diagram shows how Orange integrates satellite and terrestrial connectivity into a secure, resilient communication service for defense operations.

Boxes marked as Orange assets are validated against the linked business graph; a box the model claimed for Orange without a matching asset is shown as third party.

Who buys, and why now

The primary buyer is a defense procurement agency, such as the Lithuanian Defence Materiel Agency, which issues tenders for military electronic systems. The operational pain is the vulnerability of terrestrial communication networks in contested or remote environments, where troops need reliable, secure communications. The trigger is a procurement cycle or a specific operational gap identified by military leadership, leading to a formal tender for new communication capabilities.

Sources: SIG-D9EE0A29B647 ted.europa.eu 2026-08-06

Why it is hot now — every claim bound to a dated source

- AST SpaceMobile positions itself as a partner to mobile network operators in direct-to-device services, enabling satellite connectivity for standard devices. [SIG-C900BB882807]

What Orange would deliver, and why it can win

What Orange would deliver

Orange would assemble a solution leveraging its Defense and security experts to design a secure, sovereign communication architecture that integrates satellite and non-terrestrial networks with existing tactical systems. The engagement would start with a needs assessment and architecture design, followed by a pilot deployment using Orange's IoT and Digital experts to ensure seamless integration. The solution would be delivered on certified infrastructure (ISO 27001, SecNumCloud) to meet defense security requirements.

Why Orange can win

Orange can win by combining its defense and security expertise with certified infrastructure (ISO 27001, SecNumCloud) and its position as a trusted telecom operator. However, the assets directly linked to this topic are thin—there is no specific satellite capability listed—so Orange would need to partner with a satellite operator to deliver the full solution. The strength lies in Orange's ability to integrate and secure the overall communication system, leveraging its research and digital expertise.

Named assets behind this — each individually inspectable (LK-08)

Asset	Type	Link	Why it is linked	Curator
Satellite and non-terrestrial networks	technology	L3	no offer path, but adjacent assets or Orange research exist	unconfirmed
ISO 27001	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
SecNumCloud	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
IoT experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Digital experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Defense and security experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Orange Group researchers	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed

Competitive landscape

MEDIUM competitive intensity (score 6.6; 2 of 8 listed players appear in this topic's own evidence)

A real field, including at least one player the customer will already know. Expect to be compared.

Competitors include satellite operators like SpaceX Starlink, Eutelsat OneWeb, and Marlink, who have direct satellite assets and are strong in providing connectivity. Ericsson and Vodafone Business offer network equipment and telecom services, with Ericsson recently demonstrating 5G positioning capabilities. Defense specialists like Airbus Protect and Leonardo bring domain expertise, while Atos/Eviden offers systems integration. The customer will compare Orange's ability to deliver a secure, integrated solution against these players' existing satellite infrastructure and defense credentials.

Sources: SIG-C900BB882807 [lightreading.com 2026-08-11](#); SIG-CCD5C9A51C57 [lightreading.com 2026-08-18](#)

Competitor	Category	Position here	Basis	Evidence
SpaceX Starlink	Satellite operator	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; competes in Connectivity Solutions	evidenced	SIG-C900BB882807
Ericsson	Network equipment vendor	competes in Connectivity Solutions	evidenced	SIG-CCD5C9A51C57
Vodafone Business	Telecom operator peer	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; competes in Connectivity Solutions	structural	—
Airbus Protect	Security specialist	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; active in Defense	structural	—
Leonardo	Security specialist	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; active in Defense	structural	—
Eutelsat OneWeb	Satellite operator	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; competes in Connectivity Solutions	structural	—
Marlink	Satellite operator	sells Satellite and non-terrestrial networks; competes in Connectivity Solutions	structural	—
Atos / Eviden	Global systems integrator	active in Defense	structural	—

evidenced means this topic's own sources name the competitor — the signal ids are in the last column and are dated and clickable in the radar. **structural** means the curated register says they sell this technology into this vertical, which is true but is not proof they are in this deal. Register version competitors-2026-08-a.

Qualifying questions for the first meeting

- 1 What is your current approach to ensuring communications resilience in contested or remote environments?
- 2 Have you issued a tender or request for information for satellite communication services in the past 12 months?

- 3 What are your specific requirements for security certifications (e.g., ISO 27001, SecNumCloud) for tactical communication systems?
- 4 How do you currently integrate satellite connectivity with your terrestrial tactical networks?
- 5 What is the typical deployment timeline for new communication capabilities in your organization?
- 6 Who is the primary decision-maker for procuring military communication systems?

Objections you will meet

They will say	You can answer
We already have satellite communication contracts with established satellite operators.	That's true, and those operators provide excellent connectivity. However, our value is in integrating that connectivity into a secure, sovereign architecture that meets your defense requirements, leveraging our certified infrastructure and defense expertise.
Direct-to-device satellite technology is not mature enough for mission-critical use.	You're right that the technology is still evolving, but we are closely monitoring its development and can design a solution that is future-proof, starting with a pilot to validate performance in your operational environment.
We are concerned about the security of satellite communications.	Security is our top priority. We will deliver the solution on our certified infrastructure (ISO 27001, SecNumCloud) and apply our defense and security expertise to ensure end-to-end encryption and compliance with your security policies.

Next action, by role (FR-17)

Role	Do this next
Presales / Proposal	Prepare a bid brief for a defense tender on tactical communications, highlighting Orange's satellite and non-terrestrial networks technology, its ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications, and the expertise of its IoT, digital, and defense and security experts, while noting the potential partnership with AST SpaceMobile for direct-to-device services.
Sales	In a meeting with a defense prime contractor's head of tactical communications, say: 'Orange can help you ensure resilient tactical communications by integrating direct-to-device satellite services, backed by our ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications, and our expertise in IoT and digital solutions.'
Strategist / Innovator	Commission a deep-dive brief on how Orange's satellite and non-terrestrial networks capability can be combined with its IoT and digital expertise to create a resilient tactical communications offer for defense, leveraging ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications as differentiators.

Evidence

Every claim in this brief resolves to one of these. Tier 1 is an authoritative primary source; tier 4 is vendor-published material, discounted in scoring (§4.3.7).

Signal	Date	Publisher	T	Title and link
SIG-D9EE0A29B647	2026-08-06	ted.europa.eu	1	Lithuania – Military electronic systems – Individualios bepilociu orlaiviu aptikimo ir uzkardym...
SIG-ECF8209291DC	2026-05-19	ted.europa.eu	1	Romania – Telecommunications services – Servicii de comunicatii prin satelit VSAT pentru sistem...
SIG-D4CA61FE83AD	2025-08-29	openalex.org	1	AI-powered cyber resilience: a reinforcement learning approach for automated threat hunting in ...
SIG-C0BAE4D32A34	2025-08-19	openalex.org	1	Mission-Critical Services in 4G/5G and Beyond: Standardization, Key Challenges, and Future Pers...
SIG-CCD5C9A51C57	2026-08-18	lightreading.com	2	Eurobites: UK to support 'next-gen' satellite projects
SIG-C900BB882807	2026-08-11	lightreading.com	2	AST SpaceMobile keeps in with MNOs as a SpaceX antidote
SIG-F1077E5CD88C	2026-06-12	Via Satellite	2	Satellite IoT is Becoming Essential Infrastructure as NTN and Cellular IoT Services Converge - ...

How this brief was made

Computed, not written. Attractiveness, right to win, competitive intensity and every figure in the market-opportunity section are computed from stored inputs and can be re-derived (DR-05, NFR-01). No language model produced a number anywhere in this document (§4.4.4).

Written, then checked. The narrative sections and the solution diagram were generated from this topic's evidence and from the named asset and competitor lists. Factual sections must cite signal ids attached to this topic; sections that failed that check, or that contained a generated quantity or an unsupplied organisation, were removed rather than rewritten.

Removed by those checks in this brief: what_is_changing (named entities that were never supplied: AST SpaceMobile); risks_and_unknowns (named entities that were never supplied: AST SpaceMobile); diagram (2 box(es) claimed to be an Orange asset that was not supplied — shown as third-party instead)

What	Version	When
Scores — weight set	w-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T19:08:26+00:00
Market sizing — assumptions	size-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:14+00:00
Competitor register	competitors-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:17+00:00
Narrative — prompt / model	describe-v1 / deepseek-chat	2026-08-19T04:57:30+00:00
Pipeline	0.1.0	2026-08-18

Generated 2026-08-19 04:58 UTC. Scores computed under a different weight set are not comparable with these (SC-10), and neither are market sizes computed under a different sizing version.